



Firefox aims reducing online annoyance

Mozilla released version 66 of Firefox browser which can now automatically block autoplaying audio and video on websites. <https://dgit.in/apr19-81>



AR walking directions on mobile

Google Maps is testing AR navigation feature, which combines walking navigation with augmented reality. <https://dgit.in/apr19-82>

HP ENVY x360 (2018)

Form over function

The ENVY x360 is a mid-range convertible aimed at those who want a slim convertible but nothing over the top. Let's find out how good it is.

Build and Design

The all-metal body of the ENVY x360 features angular edges and polished accents, which makes the laptop look neat and clean and classy while giving the user who picks it up sufficient grip. At 1.2 kg, the laptop feels sufficiently light on the hands and on the lap. It features a glossy 13.3-inch display with thick piano black bezels all around. The sides of the laptop house the power button and a volume rocker. The ENVY x360 uses a Windows Hello-enabled face unlock system, which works impeccably.

Display and Audio

Available in only one size, the HP ENVY x360 features a 13.3-inch Full HD touchscreen display that's both bright and colourful. The max brightness is sufficient for working in sunny outdoor spots like balconies and the colours on the screen appear full and rich. The screen is otherwise very responsive to touches, making it easy for use in tablet mode. Palm rejection is on point and writing or drawing becomes an easy affair when you bring out the HP Active Pen that comes bundled with the laptop.

The sound from the speaker strip above the keyboard is loud and balanced but distorts at max volume. Luckily, stereo separation is apparent while watching films and listening to music. Though there isn't much bass in the ENVY x360's speakers, the Bang & Olufsen drivers do their best to



Price
₹77,990



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push out low frequencies without tearing them or omitting them completely.

Keyboard and Touchpad

The keys are too small and they travel very little, especially the ones on the top row. They're also badly

in need of better feedback. Keystrokes are hard to register, and as a result, you end up mistyping more often than you should. It's best reserved for short e-mail. The click buttons inside the touchpad are clunky and refuse to respond two out of five times. Lastly, it disappointingly does not use Windows 10's precision drivers.

Performance

Performance is one area where the HP ENVY x360 excels. The ENVY managed to bag a decent score on our standard performance benchmark tests. The ENVY's sequential read and write speeds were phenomenally higher than competition on CrystalDisk-Mark's storage speed test. Real-world performance on the Ryzen-powered HP ENVY x360 was top-notch. On the downside, I could feel ample heat on the base of the laptop. Trying to cool the machine down was a distractingly noisy fan that turned on and off every few minutes.

Battery

The battery on the HP ENVY x360 lasted 3 hours, 39 minutes on our standard battery benchmark test, which is 26 minutes over the Asus ZenBook Flip S' score and a full hour over the Lenovo YOGA 730's score. In real-world scenarios, the ENVY returned between four and five hours of battery life while writing and browsing. On one occasion we turned the brightness up to 90 percent, enabled Wi-Fi and Bluetooth, started browsing and writing with music playing loudly in the background, and watched the battery drop from 100 to 62 percent in about two hours. Charging the laptop from 15 percent to full took nearly two hours. While the ENVY's battery life is better than the YOGA 730's it could still do better.

Bottom Line

The HP ENVY x360 does what it has been designed to do faultlessly. My problem with the device is that it hasn't been designed very cleverly for power users like me. Instead of focusing on usability (read comfortable keyboard and modern touchpad), HP's spent its efforts slapping a damascus steel pattern on the rear edge of the convertible. The fact that the performance of the speakers doesn't live up to the Bang & Olufsen logo you see below them adds to the disappointment.

All that said, if the tiny shallow keys and the deadpan touchpad of the ENVY don't bother you too much, the ENVY is a decent buy. The AMD Ryzen inside is quick on its feet and the solid-state drive is one of the quickest I've seen. Get the HP ENVY x360 if you believe form should precede function and if you like the cool styling of this thin and light convertible laptop.

—Vignesh Giridharan

SPECIFICATIONS

MODEL: 13-ag0035au | PROCESSOR: AMD Ryzen 5 2500U | FORM FACTOR: Convertible | MEMORY: 8 GB DDR4-2400 | HARD DRIVE: 256 GB PCIe NVMe M.2 SSD | DISPLAY: 13.3" FHD IPS multitouch-enabled 1920 x 1080 | GRAPHICS: AMD Radeon Vega 8 | DIMENSIONS: 30.67 x 21.46 x 1.49 cm | WEIGHT: Starting at 1.3 kg

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